



Community-oriented psycholinguistics: A holistic approach

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How can we integrate these groups and make research accessible to populations it can help?

Researchers

Innovations & new findings in developmental research



Clinicians & Educators

Clinical knowledge & realistic ideas about implementation



Caregivers

Expert knowledge on caring for children and what works for families



Cochlear Implant & Hearing Aid Users

Lived experience of hearing loss



Public research reports

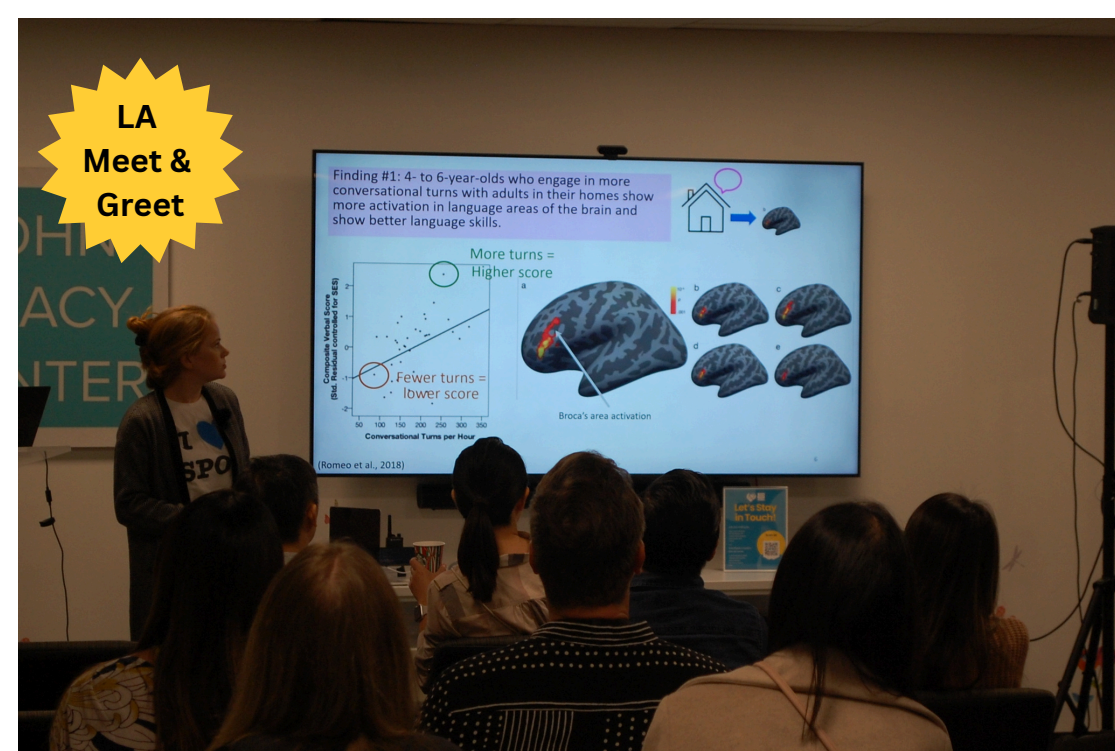
- We regularly publish reports online, synthesizing current findings in developmental research for caregivers
- Topic examples: correlations between ADHD and hearing loss, bilingualism and hearing loss
- Emphasis on making information accessible to people without a background in language science & how they can apply scientific findings to everyday life

Partnership with local preschools & volunteering efforts

- We establish relationships with local d/Deaf and hard-of-hearing schools and collaborate with them as the site for the LA Meet & Greet
- Regularly sending volunteers to partner with preschools forms personalized relationships with caregivers, clinicians, and kids



Meet and Greets for Families of Children with Hearing Loss



1. Why Meet and Greets?

- Opportunity for families of children with hearing loss to build connections with each other, and for kids to meet others using assistive listening devices like them
- 95% of children with hearing loss are born to typical-hearing parents: community support is integral!

2. Bringing Together Experts

- Allows researchers to share information with applications for education, health, and caregiving, and for caregivers to weigh in with expert knowledge on what works for kids

3. Ensuring Accessibility

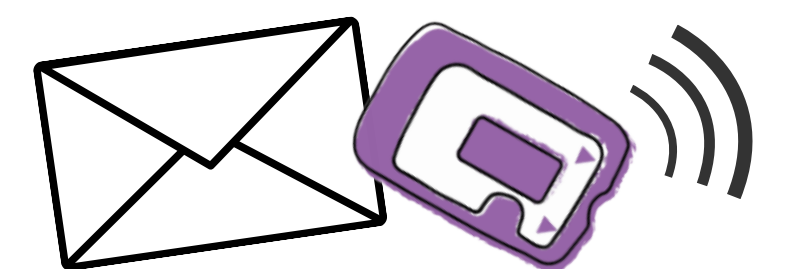
- American Sign Language (ASL) and Spanish language interpreters (especially in L.A.) are important to make sure everyone can participate
- Meet-and-Greets are on weekends and are free
- Volunteers provide activities to occupy children while caregivers attend talks & group discussions

4. How Researchers Can Benefit

- Establishes trust with potential research populations
- Creates access to more diverse subject pools outside of the area the research institution is located, and allows more people to engage with our research

Forming lasting relationships with research participants

- Families are encouraged to (and do!) reach out to us with questions about their child's development
- We aim to give information they can implement in their child's language development
- Remote options for participation are available: we send vocabulary reports, recording equipment, etc. to families via mail



Engaging kids in the lab

- Keeping a consistent theme to keep kids interested and center our research around their experience
- Creating a good experience for families leads to referrals from their friends and positive word-of-mouth reputation
- Without happy, comfortable kids and caregivers, we have no data!

